

A WORKING THEORY OF ORGANIZATIONAL FLOW

Organizations with similar people, similar technology, similar money and similar ambitions produce remarkably different results. That gap is what this paper is about.

Somebody sends a message on Tuesday morning. The answer comes Thursday afternoon. Nobody did anything wrong, and two days is a perfectly civil response time. Now multiply that by everyone currently waiting on somebody else, which is very nearly everyone.

Organizational Flow is the property underneath that: how easily information, decisions, execution and learning actually move through an organization. It rises when that movement is easy and ownership is clear. It falls when structural friction accumulates faster than value is created.

The mechanisms are rarely dramatic. Someone is not sure whose decision this is, so they check with somebody first. Checking becomes a standing meeting, and the meeting becomes how things are done here. Every step was reasonable, and nobody would defend the result.

Which leaves a question worth asking more often than it gets asked: how much more could this organization create with exactly what it already has?

Christoffer Råsten has spent twenty-five years in technology and architecture, most of it noticing why comparable organizations move at such different speeds.

More Value From What You
Already Have

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Friction – The Silent Killer

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